

CODING AGENT PROMPT — v1.2: PLAYTEST FIXES + COMBAT

Send this after the main prompt and the combat addendum.

Part A is fixes from a recorded playtest of the deployed build. Part B is the combat system, which is specified in the combat addendum but is **not in the build yet**.

Do Part A first. It is cheap and it unblocks everything else. Do not start Part B until every P0 in Part A is done.

PART A — PLAYTEST FIXES

P0 — Do these first

A1. The darkness needs a real sprite

Observed: threats render as a small red X. The four player pieces have detailed portrait sprites. The visual hierarchy is inverted — the most important moving object on the board is the least visible thing on screen.

Required: - Give each darkness tier its own sprite with a strong, distinct silhouette. - Tier must be readable at a glance without hovering. A Tier 1 Shade and a Tier 4 Abyss must not be confusable. - The darkness sprite must have equal or greater visual weight than the player pieces. - Add a small tier badge (1–4) in the corner of the tile, matching the existing letter badges on player pieces (P, D, B, L).

Done when: a new player can tell at a glance how many threats are on the board and how dangerous each one is.

A2. The houses render as missing-glyph boxes

Observed: C7, D7 and E7 display as  — tofu. The same broken glyph appears in the main-menu splash art.

Cause: the pixel font has no glyph for that codepoint.

Required: replace the text glyph with an actual sprite for the house. Two states: - **Dark** — unlit, a faint slow pulse to signal it wants something - **Lit** — warm, steady

Done when: no  appears anywhere in the app. Audit all text glyphs for the same problem.

A3. The win condition is invisible

Observed: in the playtest, cornerstones were planted at **D1** and **G2** — the top of the board, as far from the houses as possible. Neither did anything for the win condition. This was the game's own designer playing.

If the goal isn't legible to them, a new player has no chance.

Required: - Add `Houses lit: 0 / 3` to the status bar, beside `Lamp hits`. - Dark house tiles pulse faintly (see A2). - When a planted cornerstone will light one or more houses on completion, show a connecting glow between it and those houses at the moment of planting.

Done when: the goal is understood without reading any text.

P1 — Do these next

A4. Forecast view hides current threats

Observed: on turn 3 a threat at A4 is visible in **Now** and gone in **Coming**. The player loses their read of the live board when they check the forecast, and has to flip back and forth holding two states in their head.

Required: **Coming** renders everything **Now** renders, *plus* the forecast markers. It is an overlay, never a replacement.

A5. The temple square looks unlit

Observed: D4 renders darker than the lit olive squares surrounding it. The tile that generates all the light appears to be the only one without any.

Required: the temple tile is always the brightest tile on the board. It is the lamp. Per the art direction it should carry the only saturated colour on screen.

A6. Replace the sidebar "Destroy" buttons with board targeting

Observed: the sidebar lists `Destroy A4` / `Destroy G2` as text buttons. One click, instant kill, from anywhere, with no board interaction.

This removes all spatial thinking from the game's most powerful action.

Required: - Select the Destroyer → valid targets highlight **on the board**. - Click a target on the board to attack it. - With Part B in place, this opens the verse check.

Keep the 3-charge limit and the overuse counting from main prompt §6 exactly as they are.

A7. Cornerstone build delay

Observed: a cornerstone planted at D1 on turn 2 appeared to give light immediately. (Sampled at 3-second intervals, so this may be a display issue rather than a logic bug — verify before changing code.)

Required, per main prompt \$7: - On plant: `turnsRemaining = 2`. No light. - Show the countdown number **on the tile**. - Render incomplete cornerstones visibly differently from complete ones — scaffolding, not a building. - A threat entering an incomplete cornerstone destroys it.

The build delay is what forces "build when the board is quiet." Without it, planting costs nothing.

A8. Protector cover radius must always be visible

Observed: selecting the Protector shows his legal moves but never the squares he protects. His entire value is invisible unless he happens to be the selected piece.

Required: render his covered squares with a persistent faint outline at all times, regardless of selection. Brighten on selection.

P2 — Polish

A9. Two things occupied G2

A threat spawned onto the square the Destroyer was standing on. Either a spawn-collision bug, or it needs a visual for a contested square. Investigate and report which.

A10. "looser" reads as "loser"

The unit label appears lowercase as `looser`, which reads as a comparative adjective or a misspelling of "loser". Capitalise **Looser** everywhere. If it still reads badly in playtest, rename the piece rather than living with it.

A11. Coordinate labels are noise

All 49 squares carry a coordinate label. Move them to the top and left edges only.

A12. The sidebar wastes its best space

`Select a piece` plus four greyed-out buttons occupy the most valuable panel on screen.

Required: when a piece is selected, that panel shows its HP, its stats, and its passage (see Part B). When nothing is selected, show the level objective rather than a placeholder.

A13. The log is one line

`Cornerstone planted at G2` replaces whatever came before it. During the enemy phase the player cannot see what moved where.

Required: a scrolling log of the last ~10 events, with the enemy phase logged move by move.

PART B — COMBAT

The combat addendum specifies this in full. It is not in the build. Implement it now.

The rule that matters most, restated: stats decide *how hard the question is*. The verse decides *whether the attack lands*. Never `if (attack > defense) { damage }`.

B1. Stats

Piece	maxHp	Offense	Value	Defense
Protector	12	(none)	—	6
Destroyer	4	attack	8	1
Binder	10	binding	5	5
Looser	3	loosing	6	2

Tier	Name	maxHp	Attack	Defense
1	Shade	3	2	1
2	Shroud	5	4	3
3	Depth	8	6	5
4	Abyss	12	9	7

The Protector has **no offense stat** and can never initiate an attack. This is deliberate.

B2. Margin sets the check difficulty

<code>const margin = attacker.offense - defender.defense;</code>
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Margin	Blanks	Tries
<code>>= 4</code>	1	3
1 to 3	2	3
<code>-2 to 0</code>	3	2
<code><= -3</code>	4	1

B3. The verse check

Four passages, one per piece. **Do not add more.**

Piece	Passage
Protector	Psalm 91
Destroyer	Psalm 109
Binder	Matthew 16:19
Looser	Colossians 1:13

The attacker's passage is used. When a threat attacks a piece, the defending piece's passage is used.

Line selection, blank selection, hint ladder and matching are all specified in the combat addendum §6. All deterministic — no `Math.random()`.

Resolution:

```
if (passed) defender.hp -= attacker.offense; // flat, NOT reduced by defense
else      attacker.hp -= defender.attack;   // counter-blow
```

Defense was already spent setting the difficulty. Do not apply it again.

B4. Combat UI — new work beyond the addendum

On the board: - A small HP bar on every piece and every threat, always visible. Not on hover. - Damage numbers float up on resolution. - A piece or threat at 0 HP is removed with a clear animation, not a pop.

In the sidebar (see A12) when a piece is selected:

```
Binder
HP      7 / 10
Binding  5
Defense  5
Passage  Matthew 16:19
```

In the verse modal header, show the maths explicitly:

```
Binding 5 vs Defense 7 → 4 blanks, 1 try
```

One line. It teaches the whole stat system in about three encounters, with no tutorial.

Never use failure language in the check. No red, no X, no buzzer, no "Wrong". A failed try shows the next hint and the remaining count. A final failure shows the counter-blow damage plainly. The player is learning a passage, not being marked by a teacher.

B5. Healing

During UPKEEP, any piece on a **lit** square regains 1 HP, capped at maxHp. This ties survival to the light, which is the point of the game.

B6. The six-check cap

A level must never allow more than 6 verse checks. Write `tools/validateLevels.ts` to estimate the maximum from each level's spawn schedule and **fail the build** if a level can exceed it.

ACCEPTANCE

1. No ☐ glyph anywhere in the app.
2. Threat tier is identifiable at a glance without hovering.
3. Houses `lit: N / 3` visible at all times.
4. **Coming** view shows everything **Now** shows, plus markers.
5. The Destroyer is targeted on the board, never from a sidebar list.
6. Cornerstones show a visible countdown and give no light until complete.

7. Protector cover is outlined at all times.
 8. Every piece and threat shows an HP bar without hovering.
 9. The verse modal header shows the margin maths.
 10. `grep -r "Math.random" src/` still returns nothing outside cosmetic effects.
 11. All existing determinism tests still pass.
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DO NOT

- Do not add a tutorial box or tooltips to solve A3. Fix it with visual design.
- Do not surface the Destroyer overuse counter. That opacity is the whole design.
- Do not add a skip-verse option, an easy mode, or a difficulty setting.
- Do not add a fifth passage.
- Do not reduce damage by defense.
- Do not give the Protector an attack stat.
- If any of this seems wrong, stop and ask rather than improvising.